



Customer FAQ & Treatment Guide

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HEAD LICE FACT & TREATMENT PROTOCOL

General Head Lice Facts:

- Head lice are wingless creatures that have 6 legs with claws at the end. They do not hop, jump, or fly & are only able to crawl. They are the size of a sesame seed & range from grayish white to light brown in color. There is no evidence that lice transmit any disease.
- Diagnosis of head lice is most often made by finding lice eggs (“nits”) which are found within ½-inch from the scalp. Nits are oval eggs which are attached at an angle on the hair shaft & don't come off easily. If you are able blow or flick a ‘nit’ off, it is not a nit.
- Lice live for about 30 days & will lay about 6 nits/day. They cement these nits onto hair shafts. It takes 8-10 days for nits to hatch, & then another 8-10 days for nits to mature to lice.
- Nits off the hair will die within hours of hatching if they cannot find a meal.
- Head lice prefer clean heads & scalps the most. You can acquire lice from being near another person's head who has head lice or by using infested earphones, hats &/or scarves, combs, &/or brushes, etc.
- The most common symptom of head lice is itching, primarily at the base of the neck, behind the ears, & at the crown of the head. The itching is caused by an allergic reaction to the saliva that lice inject into the scalp to keep the bite from closing. Those who are not allergic to the saliva do not itch at all & may not even know they're carrying lice. Other people may continue to itch even after the lice have been eliminated.
- Check all family members hair / head at least once a week for lice & be sure to tell anyone who may have been exposed. Doing this will help prevent you from becoming re-infested.
- Pets cannot carry human head lice & do not need any type of special treatment.
- Evidence shows that lice sprays are not effective in killing lice or nits.
- **Insecticides are not useful in control on lice.**

Four Step Plan for Eliminating Head Lice:

1. **USE A PEDICULOCIDE:** Pediculocide (chemical agent) shampoo solution can be bought over the counter at your local pharmacy. Always read & follow the label carefully.

If there are any cuts or abrasions on the scalp, do not use.

Never use Pediculocide on an infant or anyone pregnant or breastfeeding.

Shampoo over the sink, not the tub or shower.

You may apply a second application of Pediculocide 8 to 10 days later to ensure all nits have been eradicated; however, if 2 treatments do not rid the issue, do not reapply or apply another product. The lice may be resistant to the product & continuous usage can cause skin damage. Instead, you'll want to call your doctor. They may recommend another type of treatment.

2. **OLIVE OIL TREATMENT:** Olive oil smothers & kills active head lice, as well as any lice that may have survived Pediculocide treatment(s).

Part the hair & apply oil directly on scalp. Massage & make sure that the oil saturates the scalp. Cover hair with shower cap & tie in place with a bandana. Leave the oil on for 8 hours.

If you wash oil off too soon, the lice will not die. They are able to hold their breath for several hours. Thus, it is important to leave the oil on for at least 8 hours.

Finally, you'll be able to comb through & remove any lice & nits. Olive oil makes nit removal easier & re-moisturizes the scalp after Pediculocide treatment(s).

3. **CLEAN ENVIRONMENT:** Drastic efforts are unnecessary to rid your home of lice. Lice depend on human blood to survive & typically die within 24-48 hours without a host.

Lice may get caught in a hairbrush, comb, or headband, so make sure to wash hair all hair care items & accessories in hot water (130F or above).

Lice may be trapped when towel-drying hair. Towels & rags used after showers or while washing the hair are one of the most likely places to find lice. Launder recently used clothes, towels, & bedding materials in hot water (130F or above) or tumble in a dryer on high heat. Stuffed animals & blankets should be washed in hot water (130F or above) or placed in a dryer on high heat. You do not need to place stuffed animals in plastic bags for several weeks, as routine cleaning will be sufficient.

Vacuum non-washable rugs, carpets, chairs & couches, pillows, bed mattresses, & car seats. Wash coats, scarves, hats & mittens, washable rugs, sheets, blankets, & pillowcases.

4. **COMB OUT THE NITS! THE FINAL & MOST IMPORTANT ACTIVITY IN LICE TREATMENT IS**

"NIT PICKING": If lice reappear after you've treated, it is usually because nits or newly hatched lice were not removed appropriately. This happens often because some of the lice are so small that they can only be seen under a microscope.

Part out thin sections of hair (no wider than the comb).

When you locate a nit, grasp the nit with your thumb & forefinger fingernails & deposit it onto a tissue.

Pin back each picked through section of hair after removing the nits in that section.

After picking all the lice & nits you can see, rinse the hair with water to wash out any loose nits.

PICK FOR NITS TWICE A DAY FOR TWO WEEKS, EVEN IF YOU DO NOT SEE NITS!

If you do not pick nits regularly, nothing else you do will work for total lice elimination!